



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: American Preparatory Academy: Draper 2
School Website: <https://draper2.americanprep.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

American Preparatory Academy Draper 2 (Draper 2) presents a public-facing program focused on values-driven literature, reading growth, and character development, with explicit emphasis on forming students to be "Smart & Good to change the world for the better." The site highlights Reading University as a core program and features parent engagement channels such as a Parent Advisory Committee (PAC). However, based on the classical education rubric and the six-element framework, the school shows limited explicit alignment with classical education hallmarks such as the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, explicit Socratic pedagogy, and a structured "living curriculum" with teachers as mentors. Overall, the school falls into the NOT CLASSICAL category, with some elements that are SOME-TIMES CLASSICAL in nature (notably formation/virtue emphasis and parent-community engagement). The aggregate assessment is driven by strong alignment in community involvement and virtue-oriented messaging, but a lack of explicit, codified classical curriculum and pedagogy signals.

Key insights at a glance: - Evidence of virtue-oriented messaging and mission: "We want students to be Smart & Good to change the world for the better," plus a Reading University program framed around values-based literature.

- Public materials emphasize parental involvement (PAC) and community engagement, aligning with the Classical emphasis on partnership with families. - Explicit classical elements like Great Books, Great Conversation, or formal Trivium/Quadrivium are not evident in the available public materials. The pedagogy appears more contemporary/reading-centered and values-based rather than explicitly classical. - Content related to Scholé (restful, contemplative learning) is present in scholarly material (The Scholé Way) but not clearly stated as a sustained, school-wide pedagogical approach on the Draper 2 site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Note: Because the aggregate rating is NOT CLASSICAL, the "What Would Move the Needle" section below notes that major needle-moving changes are not required as a formal section; however, one could interpret opportunities for growth as described in the final abstract.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- Public materials emphasize mission and values but do not explicitly articulate transcendental realism, theology, liturgical practice, or sacred communal rites. The mission centers on forming students to be “Smart & Good,” with value-oriented language rather than explicit metaphysical/-doctrinal commitments.
 - Reading University is described as “values-based literature,” signaling moral formation rather than theological instruction.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords from the Six Essential Elements lexicon related to this domain include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, and sacred. The Draper 2 materials lack explicit mentions of these transcendental anchors (e.g., theology, liturgy) and instead foreground virtue in a secular sense with “values-based literature.” Therefore, direct matches to the classical-positive indicators are minimal. No clear negative signals (e.g., secular relativism) are stated; rather, there is an absence of explicit classical religious/metaphysical commitments.
 - Quantitatively, explicit matches to the guideline-positive terms in this category are effectively 0–1 (e.g., “virtue” is not directly used; “theology”/“liturgy”/“sacred” are not present in the visible public materials). Negative keywords from the knowledge documents are also not evidenced here.
 - Why this rating
 - The school’s public-facing materials lack explicit articulation of transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, or liturgical/community sacred practices. The mission centers on character formation through values-based reading and virtue-oriented phrasing rather than a theologically grounded or liturgically integrated framework. This aligns with a NOT CLASSICAL assessment for Element 1.

Citations: The mission statement and Reading University description show the values/formation emphasis but do not reveal theology or liturgical practices.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials emphasize formation and virtue rather than pure job-readiness. The mission states a goal of forming students to be “Smart & Good,” implying moral and intellectual formation. This aligns with the classical aim of formation over information.
 - The Reading University program highlights reading and vocabulary development through a values-based framework, suggesting formation of character through literature and disciplined study, rather than a direct emphasis on modern workforce preparation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords from the Six Essential Elements (Element 2) include formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, telos, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The Draper 2 materials explicitly reference formation (via the mission’s “Smart & Good” framing) and virtue in a broader sense, though not using classical vocabulary like “telos” or “great conversation.” There is no stated emphasis on workforce-readiness or 21st-century skills as a primary objective.
 - Negative keywords would include job-preparation emphasis or skills-first framing, which are not clearly evident in the available public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly emphasizes formation and virtue as the primary educational aims, which aligns with the classical goal of education as formation. However, due to the absence of explicit articulation of the full classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty) in a rigorous, explicit manner and lack of mention of Great Books or classical ideas foundational to a fully classical curriculum, the alignment is partial. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission statement and Reading University described; formation/virtue framing evidenced.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- The Draper 2 materials emphasize a Reading University program for independent reading and values-based literature but do not document a formal classical curriculum consisting of the grammar, logic, and rhetoric trilogy, Great Books, or the Seven Liberal Arts. There is no explicit mention of studying Great Books or joining the Great Conversation in public-facing materials.
 - Documentation of history as a throughline across the curriculum (rather than social studies framing) and a history-centric approach is not visible in the public materials. The focus is on literature-based reading and virtue formation rather than a structured classical curriculum.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive classical curriculum keywords (from the Six Essential Elements) include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, and history integrated across disciplines. None of these are clearly present in the public Draper 2 materials.
 - Negative signals (from the classical corpus) about modern, project-based, or non-traditional curricula could apply, but the Draper 2 content is more about reading programs and values-based literature rather than a clearly modern, project-based, or STEM-first framing. The absence of classical content is the main driver for the NOT CLASSICAL designation in this category.
 - Why this rating
 - Without explicit mention of grammar-logic-rhetoric instruction, Great Books, or an integrated great-conversation approach, the curriculum does not align with the classical curriculum criteria. This category therefore scores NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Reading University program emphasis; mission statements that focus on values-based literature rather than Great Books or liberal-arts structure.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The presence of a Scholé-related discourse in the knowledge corpus (The Scholé Way) suggests contemplation, restful learning, and disciplined memory practices as part of classical pedagogy, though the Draper 2 site itself does not explicitly state this as a school-wide pedagogy. The Scholé material indicates the importance of memory work, contemplation, and a restful pace.
 - Draper 2 content emphasizes reading programs and value-based instruction rather than explicit Socratic seminars or rhetoric training. The absence of explicit Socratic, dialectic, or formal rhetoric instruction in public materials reduces the strength of the classical pedagogy signal, but the presence of a contemplative/restful learning frame (Scholé) in related literature signals some alignment.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators from the classical pedagogy lexicon include Socratic dialogue, memory work, chanting, Scholé/restful learning, and rhetoric instruction. The Draper 2 materials do not explicitly describe Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric instruction, but the Scholé framing in external literature indicates an awareness of contemplative pedagogy as an ideal in some classical settings.
 - Negative keywords in the classical pedagogy spectrum emphasize project-based learning, experiential learning, or student-directed inquiry as potentially non-classical when viewed as the sole approach. The Draper 2 public materials emphasize reading and values-based literature rather than a project-based, experiential-only approach.
- Why this rating
 - The pedagogy shows partial alignment via contemplative/restful learning ideas (Scholé) in external classical resources, but there is no explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars, rhetoric training, or a high-school-level rhetoric program. The evidence places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Citations: Scholé-related material cited; Reading University and mission language show emphasis on literature and formation but not explicit classical pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public Draper 2 materials emphasize mission and parent/community engagement, but do not present a clear portrait of faculty as the living curriculum, masters/mentors, or a defined “portrait of a teacher” consistent with classical ideals of teacher as exemplar. The available materials show administrative structure and program descriptions rather than a living-curriculum faculty narrative.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive classical indicators include “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty as mentors,” and “collegial culture.” The Draper 2 materials do not provide explicit statements for these facets.
 - Negative indicators would include a lack of teacher-mentorship language or a lack of faculty portraits. The current public materials do not present strong evidence for these classical faculty hallmarks.
- Why this rating
 - Given the absence of explicit statements about teachers as living exemplars, mentors, or a formal faculty culture aligned with classical Hermeneutics of Education, this category is NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission and program descriptions; lack of explicit faculty living-curriculum language in available content.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Draper 2 actively references parent involvement through the PAC (Parent Advisory Committee) and other parent-centered engagement opportunities (e.g., book clubs, gatherings). This aligns with the classical emphasis on partnership with families as co-educators and a shared mission across home and school.
 - The site also signals openness to parent involvement and community engagement, which is consistent with the classical model of education as a community endeavor involving families. The Reading University program also emphasizes ongoing reading and engagement with literature beyond the classroom.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords for Element 6 include partnership with families, parent formation, home-centered learning, parent formation, and school-parent synergy. Draper 2 content shows clear evidence of a PAC and parent involvement opportunities, which strongly align with these indicators. There is no explicit negative signal here; instead, the content supports an affirmative presence of classical-community elements.
 - The presence of open-campus orientation, parent events, and book clubs further reinforces this alignment.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates explicit, tangible engagement with parents and a structured parent-education/community approach, aligning well with the classical emphasis on parents as co-teachers and a vibrant school-community ecosystem.

Citations: PAC and parent-engagement material; open-community messaging.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school aims to become fully CLASSICAL, it would benefit from:
 - Explicit articulation of a classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) and the Seven Liberal Arts, with concrete offerings across K–12.
 - Clear description of Socratic pedagogy and seminars, plus structured rhetoric training and oratory opportunities, especially in upper grades.

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- A dedicated “living curriculum” with teacher mentors modeling virtue and classical intellectual habits, accompanied by a defined faculty culture and professional development in classical pedagogy.
 - Stronger signals of metaphysical/theological grounding or liturgical/community practices where aligned with the school’s mission, if the institution chooses this path.

Citations: Classical criteria and indicators guided by the Six Essential Elements framework. See the knowledge lexicon and elements docs for reference.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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